The Epistemic Octahedron: An Objective Surface-Based Model of Philosophical Maturity and Worldview Development

Raul Miguel Pascual Paras III
Independent Conceptual Research

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Abstract

This paper defines the *Epistemic Octahedron*, a surface-based three-dimensional model for representing philosophical maturity and worldview development. The model encodes two horizontal philosophical tensions, *empathy versus practicality* and *wisdom versus knowledge*, and one vertical dimension, *epistemic stability*. Its central claim is that philosophical maturity is not merely a subjective preference, cultural fashion, or rhetorical style. It has an objective structural limit: a state in which an individual has integrated the four horizontal dimensions without being passively dominated by unresolved imbalance among them. This state is represented by the upper vertex of the octahedron and is defined as *objective peak philosophical maturity*. The model also separates three states that are often confused: pre-philosophical absence, active negative epistemic instability, and mature integration. The coordinate origin represents a *pre-philosophical null state*; the lower vertex represents *epistemic collapse*; the upper vertex represents mature integration. This distinction is the paper's central discovery. The paper formalizes the geometry of the graph, fixes the semantics of its axes and regions, distinguishes null origin from mature balance, and establishes the Epistemic Octahedron as a formal model for treating philosophical maturity as structured, graphable, diagnostically useful, and in principle measurable. Because the model posits objective maturity, later instruments based on it must be transparent, replicable, and open to scrutiny rather than merely impressionistic.

1 Introduction

Human beings routinely distinguish between shallow and mature reasoning, between distorted and stable worldviews, and between partial opinion and reflective judgment. These distinctions are not arbitrary. They appear across ordinary life, education, politics, philosophy, therapy, religion, moral judgment, and public debate. Yet they are usually expressed through loose language rather than formal structure. A person may be called thoughtful, immature, wise, delusional, balanced, naive, rigid, practical, compassionate, or intelligent, but there is rarely a clear model showing how these judgments relate to one another.

This paper proposes such a model. It begins from a direct thesis: *there exists an objective peak of philosophical maturity.* This peak does not mean omniscience, perfect moral purity, universal

agreement, or the end of inquiry. It means a structural condition in which an individual has sufficiently integrated the major tensions involved in practical and epistemic life, and is no longer passively pulled around by unexamined imbalance among them.

The proposed model is a three-dimensional octahedral graph plotted on its *surface*, not throughout its volume. The horizontal plane contains two opposed philosophical tensions: empathy versus practicality, and wisdom versus knowledge. The vertical axis represents epistemic stability. The upper half represents positive epistemic stability. The lower half represents negative epistemic stability. The upper vertex represents objective peak philosophical maturity. The lower vertex represents epistemic collapse. The coordinate origin is reserved for a pre-philosophical null state.

This last distinction is essential. A person with no active worldview is not the same as a person with a collapsed worldview. Undeveloped absence is not delusion. Likewise, the absence of lateral imbalance at the origin is not the same as mature integration at the upper vertex. The origin lacks developed philosophical structure. The peak represents its mature completion.

The core discovery of the Epistemic Octahedron is therefore this: *pre-philosophical absence, active negative epistemic instability, and mature integration are structurally different states.* They must not be collapsed into one another. Once this distinction is made, philosophical maturity can be represented not as vague praise, but as a formal relation between integration, imbalance, and epistemic stability.

The present paper is best understood as a formal statement of a conceptual discovery. It defines the graph, its semantics, and its conceptual commitments. It does not present a finalized psychometric instrument, scoring system, gate structure, or validation protocol. Those belong to later instrument-design and empirical work. The task here is more basic: to define the objective structure that such later work would measure.

2 Why the Model Is Needed

The need for the Epistemic Octahedron arises from a failure of public and private judgment: immature and mature reasoning often appear on the same plane. A shallow slogan, a self-sealing ideology, a technical argument without wisdom, and an integrated worldview can all enter discourse as if they were merely competing opinions. When no formal distinction is available, confidence, status, emotional appeal, repetition, or social reward can substitute for maturity.

This problem became sharper under modern digital conditions. The rise of the internet did not merely spread poor ideas farther. It also changed the conditions under which reasoning is rewarded. Anonymity weakens ordinary accountability. Engagement-based incentive structures reward speed, outrage, compression, and performance. Over time, those conditions can harden into social standards: immature reasoning becomes normalized because it receives the same surface access and often greater visibility than mature reasoning.

The Epistemic Octahedron is needed because it gives that difference a formal structure. It does not simply declare a thought or worldview good or bad. It asks where the reasoning is oriented relative to integration, imbalance, and epistemic stability. A claim may use moral language while lacking practical contact. It may use technical knowledge while lacking wisdom. It may appear

compassionate while sealing itself against correction. It may appear practical while cutting itself off from human concern. The graph makes those failures locatable rather than allowing them to hide behind confidence or rhetoric.

This is also why the objective peak matters. Without a peak, philosophical evaluation collapses into opinion against opinion, preference against preference, or institution against institution. With a peak, partial and unstable reasoning can be evaluated by its distance from integrated epistemic stability. The model does not punish persons. It exposes the structure of reasoning. Where a worldview lacks reality-contact, self-correction, integration, or resistance to delusion, the graph gives that failure a position rather than granting it the same standing as mature integration.

In this sense, the model is diagnostic as well as descriptive. It identifies the kind of degradation that propaganda, ideological capture, and social performance often exploit: the substitution of persuasive surface signals for stable judgment. A metric for epistemic stability and a distinction between nullity, collapse, and objective maturity are therefore not ornamental additions to philosophy. They are necessary if philosophy is to resist being flattened into rhetoric, preference, or social momentum.

3 Core Thesis

The framework rests on five central claims.

1. Philosophical maturity has objective structure rather than being a purely subjective label.
2. That structure includes an upper limit: a state of integrated epistemic stability.
3. Philosophical imbalance can be represented across multiple dimensions at once.
4. The absence of an active worldview is categorically different from both active epistemic failure and mature integration.
5. Worldview development is diachronic: individuals, institutions, or communities may move, regress, recover, or stabilize over time.

These claims make the Epistemic Octahedron both normative and developmental. It is normative because it identifies a meaningful peak. It is developmental because it can represent trajectories rather than only static labels. A worldview may become more stable, more distorted, more integrated, more one-sided, more self-corrective, or more resistant to correction.

The two horizontal tensions are not introduced as decorative categories. They are proposed as core structural tensions of mature judgment. Empathy versus practicality captures the tension between concern for persons and contact with real-world constraint. Wisdom versus knowledge captures the tension between integrated judgment and informational grasp. The model's claim is not that no other dimensions can ever matter, but that these two opposed pairs form a powerful core structure for distinguishing mature integration from one-sided or unstable judgment.

4 The Invention of the Epistemic Octahedron

The Epistemic Octahedron is an octahedron embedded in three-dimensional coordinate space and interpreted as a map of philosophical orientation. It is plotted on the *surface* of the octahedron rather than inside a filled volume. This is not incidental. The model does not treat active worldview positions as vague mixtures inside a conceptual container. It treats them as constrained positions on a defined frontier.

Let the coordinate axes be defined as follows:

- x: practicality on one side and empathy on the other,
- z: knowledge on one side and wisdom on the other,
- y: epistemic stability, with negative values below the equator and positive values above it.

The octahedral surface for active worldview positions is given by

$$|x| + |y| + |z| = 1.$$

The semantics of each axis are directional:

- positive and negative x values represent opposed emphasis between empathy and practicality,
- positive and negative z values represent opposed emphasis between wisdom and knowledge,
- negative y values represent negative epistemic stability,
- positive y values represent positive epistemic stability.

The equatorial plane $y = 0$ is the threshold between negative and positive epistemic stability. The upper vertex $(0, 1, 0)$ represents objective peak philosophical maturity. The lower vertex $(0, -1, 0)$ represents epistemic collapse. The coordinate origin $(0, 0, 0)$ is not a surface position and is not an empirical worldview plot. It is a reserved reference point for the pre-philosophical null state, where a worldview is not yet active enough to be plotted.

Epistemic stability is represented as a distinct vertical dimension, but this does not mean it is causally isolated from the horizontal dimensions. In actual development, epistemic stability may increase through the integration of empathy, practicality, wisdom, and knowledge. The model separates these dimensions representationally so their relations can be mapped rather than assumed.

The two cross-sections below show the horizontal plane of the four foundational dimensions and the vertical axis of epistemic stability.

FIGURE 1

The Epistemic Plane: The Four Foundational Dimensions

Equatorial Cross-Section (y = 0)

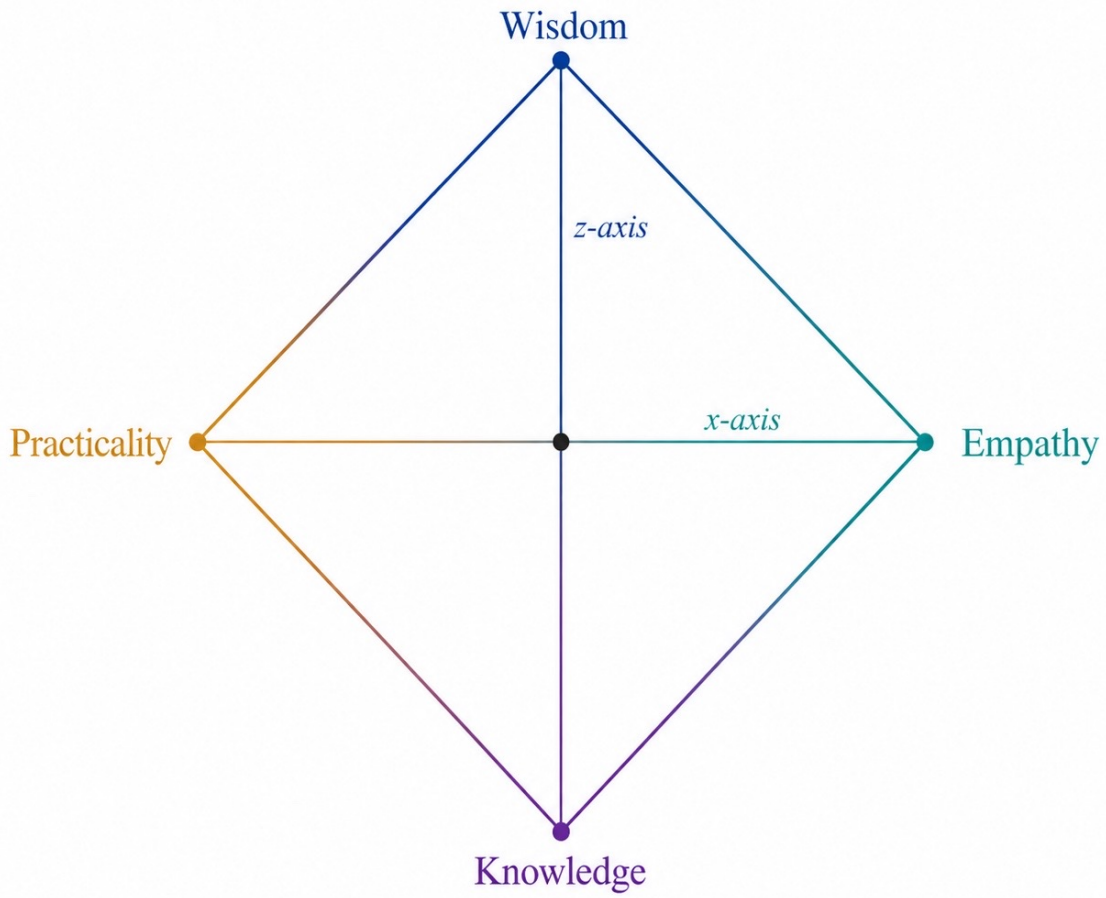
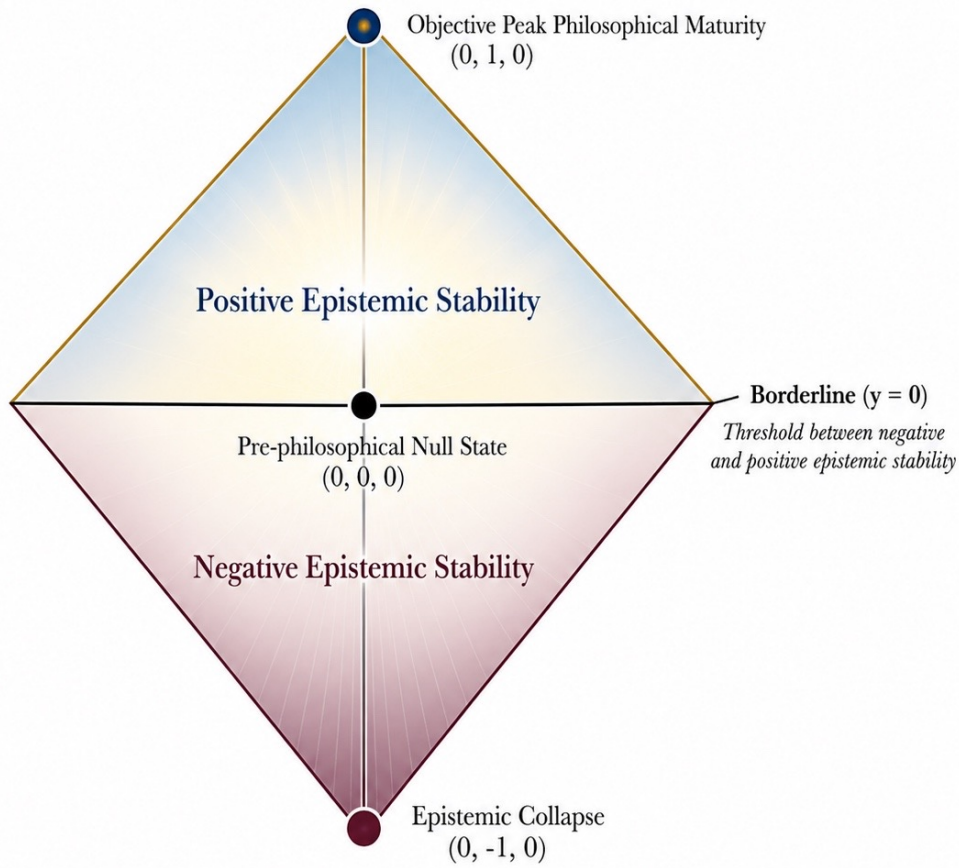


FIGURE 2
The Epistemic Axis: Side View of the Octahedron
Vertical Cross-Section Through the Axis of Integration (x = 0, z = 0)



5 Why an Octahedron

The octahedron is the correct geometry for this model because it combines opposed dimensions with a single surface constraint. The geometry matters because the model is not merely naming traits. It is representing how mature judgment relates concern, constraint, information, judgment, and epistemic stability within one structure.

First, the horizontal dimensions are bipolar tensions. Empathy and practicality are not merely separate virtues; they can compete for emphasis when judgment is immature, partial, or context-blind. Wisdom and knowledge behave similarly. Knowledge without wisdom may become technical narrowness. Wisdom without sufficient knowledge may become vague intuition. Empathy without practicality may become reality-detached sentiment. Practicality without empathy may become functional coldness. The octahedron represents these tensions without reducing them to a flat

spectrum.

The surface constraint should not be read as claiming that empathy, practicality, wisdom, and knowledge are finite substances that must be traded away against one another. It represents active philosophical orientation within the model. Lateral displacement indicates emphasis, unresolved asymmetry, or distortion depending on epistemic stability. At the upper vertex, the disappearance of lateral displacement does not mean the disappearance of the horizontal dimensions. It means their integration under maximal positive epistemic stability.

Second, the octahedron gives privileged status to vertical culmination. The top and bottom are vertices, not ordinary regions. This matches the semantics of the model. Mature integration and epistemic collapse are not merely two more positions among many. They are limiting states.

Third, the surface constraint prevents conceptual looseness. A worldview position must be placed relative to the model's dimensions. Lateral displacement, vertical stability, and distance from the peak are all part of the same structure. The graph therefore represents not only category but orientation.

Fourth, the model preserves the origin without turning the interior into plotted space. This solves a basic conceptual problem. The model needs a way to represent non-activated worldview states without confusing them with active philosophical failure. Reserving the origin for the null state achieves this without weakening the surface geometry.

6 Definitions

Definition 1 (Epistemic Stability)**.** *Epistemic stability is the degree to which a worldview remains coherent, reality-tracking, self-corrective, and resistant to delusion under internal reflection and external pressure.*

Definition 2 (Objective Peak Philosophical Maturity)**.** *Objective peak philosophical maturity is the state represented by the upper vertex of the Epistemic Octahedron. It denotes mature integration of empathy, practicality, wisdom, and knowledge under maximal positive epistemic stability.*

Definition 3 (Pre-Philosophical Null State)**.** *The pre-philosophical null state is represented by the coordinate origin* $(0, 0, 0)$*. It denotes the absence of an active worldview sufficiently formed to be plotted on the surface of the Epistemic Octahedron. Infancy is one example, but the concept is broader than age.*

Definition 4 (Epistemic Collapse)**.** *Epistemic collapse is represented by the lower vertex* $(0, -1, 0)$*. It denotes maximal active negative epistemic stability: a limiting state of deeply distorted, delusional, immature, or reality-collapsed worldview organization.*

Definition 5 (Active Worldview Threshold)**.** *The active worldview threshold is the point at which an individual's philosophy becomes developed enough to be meaningfully plotted on the octahedral surface. States prior to this threshold may be referenced by the model without being treated as active worldview positions.*

7 Referent of a Plot

The Epistemic Octahedron defines the structure of philosophical orientation. A plotted point must therefore have a referent: a whole worldview, a current philosophical state, a stance, a fragment of reasoning, a written text, an institutional orientation, or another philosophically meaningful unit of analysis. The geometry and semantics do not change across these uses. What changes is the evidential breadth of the claim being made.

A point based on a narrow fragment should not be interpreted as a certification of an entire enduring worldview. Likewise, a thin or underdetermined expression should not be mistaken for mature integration merely because it contains no explicit defect. The upper vertex represents integration relative to the referent being assessed. Stronger claims about whole-worldview maturity require evidence broad enough to support that referent.

This distinction preserves the openness of the model without weakening its objectivity. A perfect instrument that could capture an entire worldview would still use the same graph. A narrower instrument that evaluates a fragment of reasoning would also use the same graph, but its result would be limited to that fragment.

8 Null Origin and Integrated Balance

The most important distinction in the model is the distinction between two forms of non-asymmetry.

At the coordinate origin, the horizontal dimensions are not in active tension because no worldview has formed strongly enough to be plotted. This is not maturity and not pathology. It is pre-philosophical absence.

At the upper vertex, the horizontal dimensions are also no longer in unresolved lateral conflict, but for the opposite reason. They have been encountered, tested, and integrated under positive epistemic stability. This is mature balance.

The null origin and the peak may both lack lateral displacement, but they are not equivalent. One is absence before development. The other is integration after development. Confusing them would make maturity indistinguishable from non-activation.

Proposition 1. *The pre-philosophical null state at the origin and the mature integrated state at the upper vertex are structurally non-equivalent. The former is non-asymmetry by absence of worldview activation. The latter is non-asymmetry by reflective integration.*

This proposition allows the model to distinguish absence, failure, and maturity without contradiction. It also prevents the lower vertex from being misread as the beginning of development. The lower vertex is not infancy, ignorance, or neutrality. It is active epistemic collapse.

9 Interpretation of the Lower Half

The lower half of the Epistemic Octahedron is structured negative space. It should not be treated as a single undifferentiated category. It contains multiple forms of non-mature worldview organization,

including:

- distorted reality-tracking,
- immaturity,
- delusion,
- false certainty,
- refusal of correction,
- negative epistemic stability.

These conditions are related because each involves failure of mature epistemic organization, but they are not identical. The model allows them to appear in different lower-half regions depending on lateral emphasis.

A lower-half position displaced toward knowledge may indicate technical confidence without wisdom. A lower-half position displaced toward empathy may indicate concern severed from reality-contact. A lower-half position displaced toward practicality may indicate functional calculation without reflective integration. These are not the same failure. The lower half therefore represents a structured field of active instability rather than a general label for "bad" reasoning.

Passive ignorance does not by itself imply the lower vertex. A person may be uninformed, hesitant, or undeveloped without being epistemically collapsed. Deep descent in the model is reserved for stronger failures: entrenched distortion, self-sealing belief, refusal of correction, false certainty, or active reality-detachment.

This distinction is necessary because any serious model of maturity must separate ignorance, underdevelopment, one-sidedness, delusion, and collapse. Treating them as the same would destroy the model's diagnostic value.

10 Why the Null State Is Not the Lower Vertex

Because the origin represents the pre-philosophical null state, the model does not require non-activated states to be classified as negative epistemic stability. Infancy is a clear reference case of non-activated worldview, not active epistemic collapse.

Development therefore does not require literal passage through the lower vertex or every lower-half region. A worldview may emerge near the equator, in the lower half, or in the lower positive range depending on its structure. The graph distinguishes logical reference points from actual developmental trajectories.

This is one of the model's key advantages. It avoids the mistake of treating early absence as pathology while still preserving a sharp concept of active epistemic failure.

11 The Meaning of 100% Philosophical Maturity

Within this framework, 100% philosophical maturity does not mean infinite intelligence, universal agreement, emotional perfection, moral purity, or the end of inquiry. It means that the constitutive tensions of the model have been integrated under positive epistemic stability.

A mature person may still emphasize one dimension in a given context. Practicality may dominate during a crisis. Empathy may dominate in caregiving. Knowledge may dominate in technical inquiry. Wisdom may dominate in judgment under uncertainty. Such emphasis is not automatically immature. It becomes immature only when the emphasis results from neglected dimensions rather than integrated judgment.

Maturity in this model therefore means:

- the person has encountered the four dimensions rather than remaining blind to them,
- the person understands what each dimension contributes,
- the person is not trapped in one-axis reasoning,
- the person can shift emphasis without losing orientation,
- the person's worldview remains reality-tracking and self-corrective.

The peak is not a claim that a person has nothing left to learn. It is a claim about structural completion. A person at or near the peak may still acquire new information, revise conclusions, change applications, and adapt to new circumstances. What has matured is not the total amount of knowledge, but the structure by which judgment remains integrated and reality-bound.

12 Mathematical and Conceptual Representation

Let the set of active worldview positions be represented by points

$$P = (x, y, z)$$

on the octahedral surface satisfying

$$|x| + |y| + |z| = 1.$$

The coordinate origin

$$P_0 = (0, 0, 0)$$

is reserved for the pre-philosophical null state, in which a worldview is not active enough to be plotted on the surface.

The variables are interpreted semantically rather than as purely numerical quantities:

Axis	Opposed poles	Interpretation
x	Empathy / Practicality	Orientation toward persons and concern versus functional demands and real-world constraint
z	Wisdom / Knowledge	Orientation toward integrated judgment versus information, technical grasp, or accumulated fact
y	Negative / Positive epistemic stability	Degree of coherence, reality-contact, self-correction, maturity, and resistance to delusion

The upper vertex is

$$P_{\text{peak}} = (0, 1, 0),$$

which represents mature integration at maximal positive epistemic stability.

The lower vertex is

$$P_{\text{collapse}} = (0, -1, 0),$$

which represents epistemic collapse at maximal active negative epistemic stability.

Any equatorial point satisfies $y = 0$ and represents the threshold between negative and positive epistemic stability. Lateral displacement away from the vertical axis indicates emphasis, unresolved asymmetry, or distortion depending on the level of epistemic stability.

This paper defines the geometry and semantics of the model. Operational scoring, instrumentation, and validation belong to later work. That limitation does not weaken the model's theoretical claim. It clarifies the difference between defining a structure and building instruments to measure it.

13 Novelty of the Framework

The Epistemic Octahedron contributes five original moves.

First, it treats philosophical maturity as graphable in a strict geometric sense rather than as a loose metaphor.

Second, it separates three states that are often blurred together: pre-philosophical absence, active negative epistemic instability, and mature integration.

Third, it distinguishes multiple forms of lower-half instability instead of treating immaturity, delusion, ignorance, and collapse as one flat category.

Fourth, it is diachronic. The graph does not assign a final essence to a person. It allows successive plots across time. A worldview may gain stability through correction, responsibility, reflection, and reality-contact, or lose stability through false certainty, distortion, self-sealing logic, or delusion.

Fifth, it preserves context-sensitive emphasis. Mature philosophy is not frozen neutrality. It is integrated flexibility. A mature worldview can apply different dimensions in different contexts without collapsing into imbalance.

14 Applications

Because this paper states a conceptual discovery and formalizes it as a diagnostic model, the Epistemic Octahedron has direct applications.

14.1 Philosophical Anthropology

The graph offers a way to discuss human development as more than intelligence, moral sentiment, or social conditioning. It integrates epistemic, practical, ethical, and reflective dimensions into one structure.

14.2 Education

Educational systems often train knowledge while undertraining wisdom, or train empathy while neglecting practical judgment. The model can be used to think about curricula aimed at integrated maturity rather than one-dimensional optimization.

14.3 Psychology and Counseling

Reflective or therapeutic work often encounters people who are intelligent but unstable, compassionate but reality-detached, practical but unreflective, or wise in some domains while distorted in others. The graph gives language for these patterns.

14.4 AI Alignment and Human Modeling

Artificial systems that model or assist human reasoning require structures richer than preference lists, policy compliance, or utility maximization. The Epistemic Octahedron offers a formal structure for modeling maturity, imbalance, and worldview organization.

14.5 Longitudinal Worldview Research

The framework can support longitudinal study in which individuals are plotted repeatedly over time. This would make it possible to observe whether crises, education, ideology, trauma, responsibility, or reflection alter philosophical position in patterned ways.

14.6 Civilizational and Institutional Analysis

The model can also be applied above the individual level. Institutions, communities, and political movements may display worldview patterns analogous to individuals: high knowledge with low wisdom, high empathy with low practicality, practical competence with low epistemic stability, or moral language detached from reality-contact.

15 Scope of the Present Paper

This paper defines the Epistemic Octahedron as a formal model of a conceptual discovery. Its task is to establish the geometry, central distinctions, and semantic structure of the framework.

It does not finalize a scoring system, rubric, gate set, weighting scheme, empirical instrument, or validation protocol. Those belong to later measurement and benchmarking work. The present contribution is prior to those tasks: it defines what the instrument would be measuring.

Because the model makes an objective claim, any candidate instrument based on it must be held to a higher standard than impressionistic interpretation. A claim of objective maturity cannot rest on private intuition, evaluator status, or rhetorical confidence. The stronger the claim, the stronger the demand for scrutiny.

Accordingly, any candidate instrument that claims to measure positions on the Epistemic Octahedron must be transparent, replicable, and semantically faithful to the graph. It must disclose the referent of the plot, the evidence used, the rules by which evidence is interpreted, and the way those rules produce or support a position. It must apply stable standards across cases rather than changing criteria to fit a preferred result. A non-transparent or non-replicable instrument would not be measuring the Epistemic Octahedron in a meaningful sense; it would only be borrowing its vocabulary.

This requirement follows from the model itself. If philosophical maturity is objective, then its measurement must be open to correction, pressure, and independent review. Otherwise the instrument would violate the very epistemic stability it claims to assess.

16 Potential Objections

16.1 Objection 1: Philosophical maturity cannot be objective

A common objection is that philosophical maturity is culturally relative or irreducibly subjective. The answer is that disagreement about measurement does not erase structure. Human beings disagree about justice, wisdom, truth, and maturity, yet still make persistent distinctions between shallow and mature reasoning. The Epistemic Octahedron formalizes that distinction rather than pretending all reasoning structures are equal.

16.2 Objection 2: The upper vertex risks dogmatism

A second objection is that positing a peak invites authoritarian certainty. The model avoids this because the peak is not a doctrine. It is not agreement with a fixed ideology, institution, or conclusion. It is integrated consideration under positive epistemic stability. A mature worldview remains open to correction because reality-contact and self-correction are part of maturity itself.

16.3 Objection 3: The model may confuse null origin with pathology

This objection applies only if the lower half is read too crudely. The model explicitly prevents that confusion. The origin is the null state. The lower vertex is active collapse. The lower half contains active forms of negative epistemic organization. Pre-philosophical absence is not pathology.

16.4 Objection 4: Four dimensions may be incomplete

The model does not need to claim that empathy, practicality, wisdom, and knowledge exhaust every possible philosophical dimension. It claims that these four dimensions define a powerful core structure for maturity analysis. Later extensions may refine the framework without dissolving its central distinction between null absence, negative instability, and mature integration.

17 Broader Significance

The significance of the Epistemic Octahedron is that it restores structure to a domain often reduced either to opinion or intelligence. If philosophy is treated as mere opinion, maturity disappears. If maturity is reduced to intelligence, ethical and practical integration disappear. The Epistemic Octahedron avoids both reductions.

The model keeps evaluation while making the criteria structural. It keeps objectivity without pretending measurement is already finished. It keeps development without assuming growth is linear. It identifies a peak without claiming that every non-peak position is the same kind of failure.

Because the model defines objective peak philosophical maturity, the standard it names is not private property of any institution, credential class, ideology, or elite group. It is a public standard of development. It can be argued about, tested, refined, and applied in common. Its objectivity does not exempt it from scrutiny; it requires scrutiny.

If developed further, the framework can support worldview cartography, maturity diagnostics, philosophical education, developmental modeling, institutional analysis, and machine-assisted interpretation of philosophical stance.

18 Conclusion

This paper has defined the Epistemic Octahedron as an objective surface-based model of philosophical maturity and worldview development. The model places empathy, practicality, wisdom, and knowledge on opposed horizontal axes, and epistemic stability on the vertical axis. Its central discovery is that pre-philosophical absence, active negative epistemic instability, and mature integration are structurally different states.

The coordinate origin represents the pre-philosophical null state. The lower vertex represents epistemic collapse. The upper vertex represents objective peak philosophical maturity. From this follows the paper's main thesis: philosophical maturity has an objective upper limit, representable

as the upper vertex of the graph.

The Epistemic Octahedron is therefore not merely a visual metaphor. It is a formal model for worldview development. It distinguishes immaturity from delusion, asymmetry from contextual emphasis, and null origin from mature balance. It unifies developmental, epistemic, ethical, and practical analysis within one geometric structure.

Whether future work validates, revises, or extends the framework, the core contribution remains: the paper identifies and formalizes a structural distinction that ordinary language often blurs, and it establishes a research program centered on objective philosophical maturity.

Appendix: Compact Summary of the Model

Feature	Meaning
Shape	Octahedron plotted on its surface for active worldview positions
Base axes	Empathy versus practicality; wisdom versus knowledge
Vertical axis	Epistemic stability
Origin	Pre-philosophical null state
Upper half	Positive epistemic stability
Lower half	Negative epistemic stability and related active non-mature conditions
Top vertex	Objective peak philosophical maturity
Bottom vertex	Epistemic collapse, or maximal active negative epistemic stability
Equator	Threshold between negative and positive epistemic stability
Key discovery	Null origin, negative instability, and mature integration are structurally different
Main contribution	A graphable, developmental, and in principle measurable model of worldview maturity